Salic Biston Dumarpa

Sultan Atty. Salic Biston Dumarpa is a Filipino lawyer, jurist, and respected Meranaw civic leader whose career carried him from the prosecutorial trenches of Lanao del Sur all the way to the national labor bench, and eventually into decades of grassroots advocacy for the Bangsamoro people.

He is best remembered for three overlapping identities that rarely sit in one man: a career prosecutor who rose to become a Regional State Prosecutor for the Department of Justice, a Presiding Commissioner of the National Labor Relations Commission who spent over a decade ruling on labor disputes across Mindanao, and a traditional Sultan whose word still carries weight among the Meranaw of Lanao del Sur.

Contents

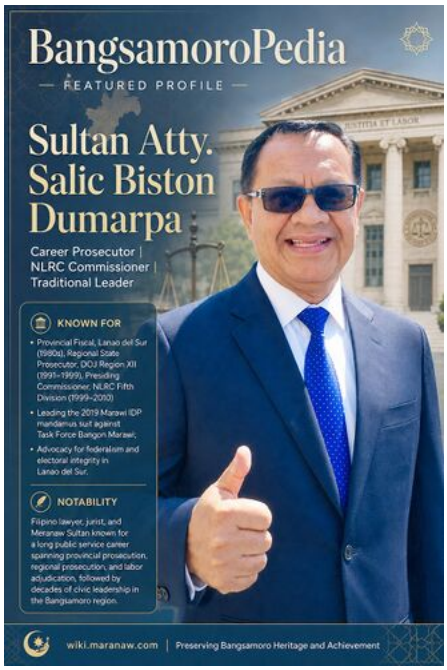
1 EARLY LIFE AND FAMILY
2 EDUCATION
3 CAREER AND INSTITUTIONAL CONTRIBUTIONS
  3.1 Department of Justice (1980s–1999)
  3.2 National Labor Relations Commission (1999–2010)
4 POLITICAL ACTIVITIES AND JURISPRUDENCE
5 INVOLVEMENT IN BANGSAMORO CIVIC MOVEMENTS
  5.1 The Post-Siege Marawi Rehabilitation Campaign (2019)
  5.2 Electoral Integrity and Anti-Corruption Mobilization
  5.3 Advocacy for Federalism in the Bangsamoro
6 AWARDS, RECOGNITION, AND LEGACY
7 SEE ALSO
8 REFERENCES

EARLY LIFE AND FAMILY

Dumarpa was born and raised in Lanao del Sur, the landlocked heartland of the Meranaw people on the shores of Lake Lanao. He grew up immersed in two systems of order at once: Islamic tradition and the Meranaw concept of *Maratabat*, the clan honor and status system that still shapes public life in the province. In time, he was elevated to the traditional royal title of Sultan, a recognition that placed him at the head of both a clan and a broader responsibility to the Moro community around him.

Public service runs deep in the Dumarpa household. He is married to Hon. Faysah Racman Pimping Maniri Dumarpa, who represented the 1st District of Lanao del Sur in the House of Representatives

Sultan Atty. Salic Biston Dumarpa



Full Name

Salic Biston Dumarpa

Titles

Sultan; Attorney

Ethnicity

Meranaw (Maranao)

Home Province

Lanao del Sur, Philippines

Notable Positions

Provincial Fiscal, Lanao del Sur (1980s)
Regional State Prosecutor, DOJ Region XII (1991–1999)
Presiding Commissioner, NLRC Fifth Division (1999–2010)

Spouse

Hon. Faysah Racman Pimping Maniri Dumarpa, former Representative, 1st District of Lanao del Sur

Children

Atty. Faydah Maniri Dumarpa, Commissioner, Commission on Human Rights

Alma Mater

National College of Business and Arts (BSBA); University of the East College of Law (LL.B.)

before he himself sought the same seat after her term ended. Their daughter, Atty. Faydah Maniri Dumarpa, carries the family's legal tradition forward: she was appointed by President Ferdinand Marcos Jr. as a Commissioner of the Commission on Human Rights in December 2022, taking her seat on the Sixth Commission En Banc for a term running to 2029.

Notability

Filipino lawyer, jurist, and Meranaw Sultan known for a long public service career spanning provincial prosecution, regional prosecution, and labor adjudication, followed by decades of civic leadership in the Bangsamoro region.

Known For

Serving as Presiding Commissioner of the NLRC Fifth Division; leading the 2019 Marawi IDP mandamus suit against Task Force Bangon Marawi; advocacy for federalism and electoral integrity in Lanao del Sur.

EDUCATION

Dumarpa studied in Manila before returning home to practice law. He is said to have earned a Bachelor of Science in Business Administration, majoring in Accounting, from the National College of Business and Arts, and later a Bachelor of Laws from the University of the East College of Law, a school with a long track record of producing lawyers and public officials. He subsequently passed the Philippine Bar Examination, which opened the door to his decades in public service. *(Note: these educational details come from a submitter-provided source and are pending independent confirmation. See internal notes.)*

CAREER AND INSTITUTIONAL CONTRIBUTIONS

Department of Justice (1980s–1999)

Dumarpa's career in public prosecution began at home, where he served as Provincial Fiscal of Lanao del Sur (the position now called Provincial Prosecutor) through the late 1980s. It was in this role that he found himself at the center of a Supreme Court case that still gets cited in law school today.

In 1988, a legal opinion issued by Dumarpa's office, regarding who rightfully held the mayoralty of Marogong, Lanao del Sur, put him on a collision course with the Commission on Elections. COMELEC found Dumarpa and two colleagues in contempt over the opinion, fining them 500 pesos each. Dumarpa fought back, and in *Dumarpa v. Dimaporo* (G.R. Nos. 87014-16, September 13, 1989), the Supreme Court reversed the contempt finding, ruling that there was no clear showing of intent to undermine COMELEC's authority and that the fiscals had simply been doing their job when asked for a legal opinion. The case remains a reference point on good-faith legal advice given by government lawyers in the course of their duties.

In January 1991, Dumarpa was promoted to Regional State Prosecutor for DOJ Region XII, covering Central Mindanao. He held the post for roughly eight years, overseeing every Provincial and City Prosecution Office in the region during a period when the area was, as it still can be, a difficult place to keep the machinery of justice running smoothly. He is credited with pushing for faster, more efficient preliminary investigations across offices that were often stretched thin.

National Labor Relations Commission (1999–2010)

In January 1999, Dumarpa moved from criminal prosecution into labor adjudication when he was appointed Presiding Commissioner of the NLRC's Fifth Division, based in Cagayan de Oro. He held the post for more than a decade, until March 2010, and his name appears on a long list of Supreme Court cases from that period as the presiding officer whose division decisions were being reviewed on appeal, among them *Retuya v. Dumarpa* (G.R. No. 148848, August 5, 2003) and disputes involving companies and workers across Northern and Central Mindanao.

As Presiding Commissioner, Dumarpa sat at the head of a division that heard appeals from labor arbiters across the region, weighing workers' rights against employers' obligations under the Labor Code. Reporting from that period shows him signing off on decisions that favored reinstated workers as often as those that sided with management, the ordinary rhythm of a quasi-judicial body doing its job on a contested, case-by-case basis.

POLITICAL ACTIVITIES AND JURISPRUDENCE

After stepping down from the NLRC in 2010, Dumarpa made a run at elected office, contesting the congressional seat for the 1st District of Lanao del Sur, the very seat his wife had just vacated, in the May 10, 2010 automated national elections.

The race against his opponent, Hussin Pangandaman, turned into one of the messier contests of that election cycle. COMELEC declared a total failure of elections in seven municipalities, three of them in Dumarpa's own district: Masiu, Lumba Bayabao, and Kapai. Special elections were rescheduled more than once because of missing ballots and election officials unwilling to serve. When COMELEC issued Resolution No. 8965 governing how those special elections would be run, Dumarpa, who was narrowly leading in the areas where voting had gone through cleanly, challenged two of its provisions before the Supreme Court, arguing they were adopted without proper notice and would tilt the special elections against him.

The Court never got to rule on the merits in the way Dumarpa hoped. In *Dumarpa v. Commission on Elections* (G.R. No. 192249, April 2, 2013), the justices found the petition moot: the special elections had already gone forward, and Pangandaman had already been proclaimed the winner. Still, the Court used the case to affirm COMELEC's broad constitutional and statutory authority to re-cluster precincts, reconstitute boards of election inspectors, and adjust residency requirements for poll workers during emergencies, powers that election lawyers still point to today. The case is a routine but real part of the country's election jurisprudence, even if it did not end the way Dumarpa wanted.

INVOLVEMENT IN BANGSAMORO CIVIC MOVEMENTS

Retirement from government did not slow Dumarpa down. If anything, the years after 2010 are when his civic profile in Lanao del Sur grew the most, built around post-conflict rehabilitation, clean elections, and constitutional reform for the Bangsamoro.

The Post-Siege Marawi Rehabilitation Campaign (2019)

The 2017 Marawi Siege left tens of thousands of Meranaw residents displaced, many of them barred for years from returning to the city's "Most Affected Area" while government clearance and unexploded ordnance disposal dragged on. By December 2019, frustration had turned into legal action.

Acting as chairman of the Go Right Foundation Inc., Dumarpa helped lead close to 400 displaced Marawi residents in filing a class suit before the Marawi Regional Trial Court. The petition, a writ of mandamus with a prayer for preliminary mandatory injunction, was directed at HUDCC Secretary Eduardo del Rosario, who chaired Task Force Bangon Marawi, and Marawi City Mayor Majul Gandamra. Dumarpa argued publicly that the bureaucratic delay had wrecked residents' livelihoods, businesses, and their children's schooling. The pressure appears to have worked, at least in part: government reporting from that period shows building permits finally being released to Marawi residents in the months that followed.

Electoral Integrity and Anti-Corruption Mobilization

Dumarpa has also been a persistent voice against the political warlordism, vote-buying, and electoral fraud that have long plagued Lanao del Sur and the old ARMM. He is said to have worked with retired Moro officers from the AFP and PNP to mobilize hundreds of voters into filing formal affidavits documenting local corruption and fraudulent election practices, and to have carried those grievances directly to Malacañang. *(Note: this specific mobilization is sourced from submitter materials and is pending independent confirmation. See internal notes.)*

Advocacy for Federalism in the Bangsamoro

As a man who understood both the Philippine legal code and Meranaw *Adat* (customary law), Dumarpa became an advocate for federalism as a long-term fix for a region he felt had long been shortchanged by centralized rule from Manila. He is said to have served as Provincial Chairman of the Marawi City and Lanao del Sur chapters of the MRRD-NECC (Masa Masid / Movement for Reform and Regional Development - National Executive Coordinating Committee), campaigning alongside other Moro leaders for a shift to a federal system that would guarantee the Bangsamoro genuine self-determination and fiscal autonomy. *(Note: this civic role is sourced from submitter materials and is pending independent confirmation. See internal notes.)*

AWARDS, RECOGNITION, AND LEGACY

Over the course of his career, Dumarpa is said to have received recognition from regional organizations, legal fraternities, and Islamic civic groups for his work on justice and peaceful dispute resolution. *(Note: specific awards are not yet itemized or independently verified. See internal notes.)*

What is well documented is the shape of his legacy: a Moro jurist who built a career inside the country's secular legal institutions while never setting aside his role as a traditional Sultan. That dual footing, part magistrate, part customary leader, let him move between two systems of law that do not always speak to each other, and to be taken seriously in both. In Marawi City and across Lanao del Sur, he remains regarded as an elder statesman of sorts, someone whose opinion on both legal and communal matters still carries weight.

SEE ALSO

- Faysah Racman Pimping Maniri Dumarpa
- Faydah Maniri Dumarpa
- Marawi Siege
- National Labor Relations Commission
- Lanao del Sur

REFERENCES

- Supreme Court of the Philippines, *Dumarpa v. Dimaporo*, G.R. Nos. 87014-16, September 13, 1989.
- Supreme Court of the Philippines, *Retuya v. Dumarpa*, G.R. No. 148848, August 5, 2003.
- Supreme Court of the Philippines, *Dumarpa v. Commission on Elections*, G.R. No. 192249, April 2, 2013.
- Philippine News Agency, "Gov't issues building permits to Marawi IDPs," December 2019.
- Philippine Daily Inquirer, "Marawi rehab delay worsens poverty," December 2019.

- Commission on Human Rights, "CHR welcomes Atty. Faydah M. Dumarpa as the new addition to the sixth Commission en banc," January 2023.
- GMA News Online, "CHR welcomes new commissioner," January 2023.
- MindaNews, "Mindanao's elected: same faces, same family names (3): The Representatives," June 2010.

Editorial Notice: BangsamoroPedia is a curated knowledge archive. Its pages are maintained by the editorial administrator to help ensure historical accuracy. If you would like to suggest corrections, share sources, or contribute information, please message the administrator through the official Facebook page: **Notable Muslim Filipinos**.

Retrieved from "https://wiki.maranaw.com/index.php?title=Salic_Biston_Dumarpa&oldid=2921"